CARD MODERNIZATION / 2026

A smarter path to card modernization.

A six-week, data-driven engagement to prioritize contactless card replacements, control unnecessary early replacement costs, and deliver an actionable modernization roadmap.

PREPARED FOR

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Source: Bear Down Bank card extract, Sept. 30, 2026. Cost calculated at $8 per card.
Prepared for Data Visualization, University of Arizona. Course scenario using a provided dataset.

01 / THE CHALLENGE

Replacing all 1,693 cards early would *overlook the value of timing.*

THE PRODUCT GAP

1,693

Non-contactless cards

29.2% of the 5,802-card portfolio

THE COST EXPOSURE

$13,544

If every non-contactless card were replaced early.

1,693 cards × $8 per card

THE EXISTING PROCESS

At expiry

Cards are automatically replaced in their expiration month.

Timing determines whether early action is worthwhile.

THE BUSINESS TRADEOFF

The bank must close its contactless gap without paying to replace cards that are already approaching their normal replacement date.

Source: Bear Down Bank card extract, Sept. 30, 2026. Early replacement estimate: $8 per card.

02 / THE APPROACH

A three-stage assessment turns card data *into an actionable replacement roadmap.*

01 / AUDIT

WEEKS 1-2

Validate the portfolio

Which non-contactless cards remain, and when do they expire?

Reconcile customer and card records, then verify contactless status, expiration dates, and data completeness.

OUTPUT: VALIDATED CARD SEGMENTS

02 / PRIORITIZE

WEEKS 3-4

Evaluate replacement options

Which cards justify early replacement, and at what cost?

Compare expiration-based scenarios, validate the $8 replacement cost, and identify priority cards.

OUTPUT: COSTED REPLACEMENT PLAN

03 / VALIDATE

WEEKS 5-6

Prepare for rollout

What must be confirmed before implementation?

Review operational constraints, rollout dependencies, and success measures.

OUTPUT: IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

WHAT BEAR DOWN BANK RECEIVES

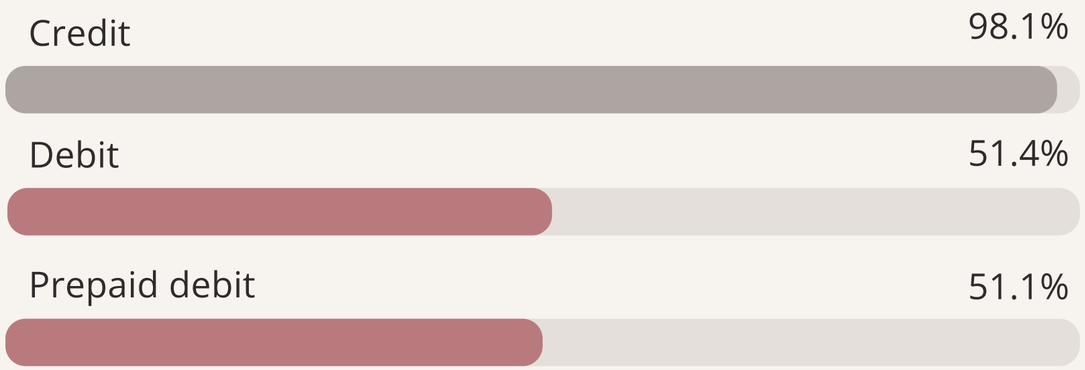
A validated portfolio assessment, costed replacement scenarios, and an implementation roadmap for executive review.

Proposed six-week planning engagement

03 / THE EVIDENCE

Debit and prepaid cards lag *behind credit in adoption.*

CONTACTLESS ADOPTION BY CARD TYPE



Source: Exploratory Tableau dashboard, Oct. 18, 2026

THE ADOPTION GAP

~47 pts

Credit contactless adoption exceeds debit and prepaid debit by approximately 47 percentage points.

WHY THE GAP EXISTS

Debit cards became contactless in January 2024. Prepaid debit followed in July 2025. Older cards may remain in circulation until expiration.

THE STRATEGIC DECISION

Expiration timing, not card type alone, should guide early replacements so the bank prioritizes customers who would otherwise wait longest.

Source: Bear Down Bank card portfolio analysis, September 30, 2026.

04 / FROM INSIGHT TO ACTION

Prioritize 211 long-dated cards *for $1,688 in early replacement costs.*

RECOMMENDED EARLY REPLACEMENT BATCH

211 cards

ESTIMATED COST

$1,688

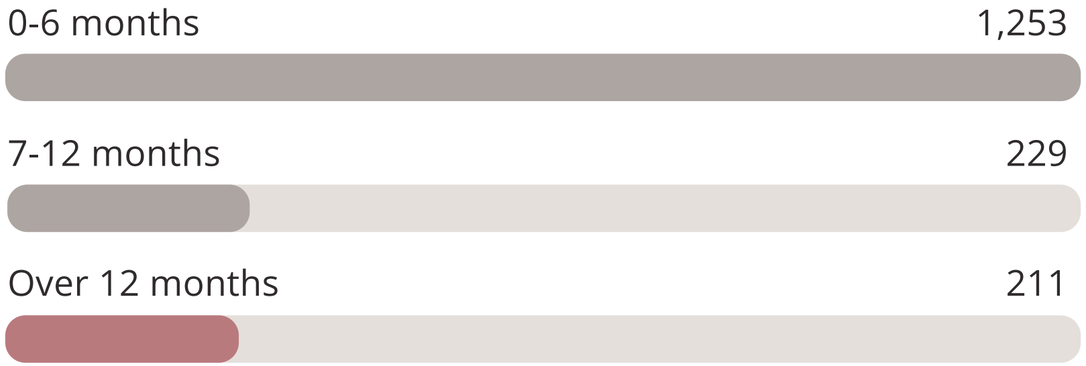
CALCULATION

211 cards x $8 per card

WHY THESE CARDS?

These 211 non-contactless cards have more than 12 months remaining before expiration, making them the longest-waiting group under the normal replacement cycle.

NON-CONTACTLESS CARDS BY EXPIRATION



Source: Flex 10 example

THE RECOMMENDATION

Prioritize the 211 long-dated cards for eligibility and operational validation. Allow the remaining 1,482 non-contactless cards to follow their normal expiration cycle.

Source: Bear Down Bank card extract, Sept. 30, 2026. Estimate: $8 per card.

05 / THE ENGAGEMENT

Six weeks. Three milestones.

One decision-ready roadmap.

W1	W2	W3	W4	W5	W6

MILESTONE 01: END OF WEEK 2

Portfolio baseline confirmed

Reconcile both data extracts, verify card counts and expiration windows, and flag missing or inconsistent records.

HAND OFF

Validated portfolio and eligibility assumptions

MILESTONE 02: END OF WEEK 4

Replacement scenarios costed

Confirm the $8 cost assumption, compare replacement windows, and validate the proposed 211-card priority batch.

HAND OFF

Cost comparison and recommended batch

MILESTONE 03: END OF WEEK 6

Roadmap ready for approval

Document rollout dependencies, operational checks, success measures, and the next implementation decision.

HAND OFF

Executive-ready modernization roadmap

ENGAGEMENT READY

Included: data validation, cost modeling, prioritization, and rollout planning.

Excluded: physical card replacement and vendor execution. Implementation requires separate approval.

Proposed milestones; timing begins upon engagement kickoff.

06 / THE BUSINESS CASE

The investment isn't in replacing 211 cards.
It's in knowing which cards to replace next.

THE EXECUTIVE'S QUESTION

“Why hire consultants for a $1,688 replacement batch?”

Because the engagement produces a repeatable decision framework. Not just a replacement list. Bear Down Bank can use it to evaluate future batches, control early replacement spending, and make informed rollout decisions.

07 / THE DECISION

Approve a six-week planning engagement.

Modernize with confidence, not guesswork.

Authorize Rock & Co. Analytics to validate the initial 211-card opportunity and deliver a cost-conscious modernization roadmap for executive review.

REQUESTED APPROVAL

A six-week planning engagement, subject to contracting and budget approval.

EXPECTED DELIVERABLES

Validated card segments, costed replacement scenarios, and an implementation roadmap.

Approval today authorizes planning—not automatic replacement of the 211 candidate cards.